

Self-Introduction & Interview Prep Guide

Self-intro structure, a sample script, and behavioural interview prep

1. Self-Intro: Tips and Tricks

A self-intro is not your whole resume read aloud. It is a short, well-ordered story that tells the interviewer three things: what you know, what you have built, and why you want this specific job. Keep it to 90 seconds to 2 minutes. Follow this order:

1. Opening - who you are

Name, branch (Information Science and Engineering), year (4th year), college (NMAM Institute of Technology). Thank the interviewer briefly for the opportunity. Then, in one line, summarise your skill area - pick this based on the role you're applying for, don't list everything.

- Example for a dev role: "I'm someone who enjoys building full-stack applications and has recently been exploring agentic AI."
- Example for an analytics role: "I'm inclined towards data analytics and enjoy working with data to find patterns that drive decisions."

Say only what's relevant to the role. Don't list five unrelated interests - it dilutes the intro and invites off-target questions.

2. Internship project

Talk about this before your academic projects, since it usually carries the most weight. Cover, in order:

- Company you interned at, and the timeframe.
- The problem or idea the project addressed - explained simply, like you'd explain it to a non-technical person.
- How the solution worked, at a concept level (what it did, not a list of frameworks).
- Your individual contribution - be specific about what you personally built or owned, not just what the team did.

You must be ready to go deep on this if asked. Interviewers often spend the most follow-up time here, so know the architecture, the decisions you made, the trade-offs, and any numbers (performance, scale, users) cold.

3. Academic / group projects

Cover these briefly, but the interviewer should walk away knowing about every project listed in your resume's project section - the self-intro is often the only chance you get to plant that before Q&A starts. For each project mention:

- The idea - what problem it solves, in plain language.
- How you approached and solved it.
- Your specific contribution in the team.

Do not list the tech stack ("built with React, Node, MongoDB..."). Interviewers rarely care about the stack in the self-intro - they want the idea and the approach. Save stack details for when they ask. As with the internship, be ready for depth - know your project well enough to defend design choices.

4. Leadership / involvement

One or two sentences only. Mention a club role, an event you organised or volunteered for, or similar, and what you took away from it (ownership, coordination, communication). Don't over-explain - this section exists to round out the picture, not to be the focus.

5. A hobby

One genuine hobby or interest outside academics. Keep it short and honest - this is where the interviewer sees a bit of personality, and it's an easy, low-stakes talking point if they want to lighten the conversation.

6. Why this company - and thank you

Close by saying why you specifically want to join this company. This needs real research - a product they've built, a value they're known for, a problem area they work in that excites you, or a specific team/technology alignment. Vague lines like "I want to grow and learn" don't land - they sound the same for every company. End with a short thank you.

Other things to keep in mind

- Practice it out loud, don't memorise it word for word - it should sound natural, not recited.
- Match your one-line skill summary to the job description before every interview.
- Keep the whole thing concise - depth comes later in the Q&A, not in the intro.
- Everything you say is an invitation for a follow-up question. Don't mention anything you can't defend.

2. Generic Self-Intro Example

This is a sample structure you can adapt. Replace the bracketed parts with your own details and trim it to fit your own experience.

Good morning/afternoon, thank you for the opportunity to interview with [Company Name]. My name is [Your Name], I'm a final year student, 4th year, from the Information Science and Engineering branch at NMAM Institute of Technology.

I'm someone who enjoys [one line - e.g. building full-stack web applications and has recently been getting into agentic AI systems].

Talking about my internship - I interned at [Company Name] as a [Role] intern, where I worked on [one-line idea of the project, e.g. a system to automate invoice reconciliation for finance teams]. The core problem was [brief problem statement], and the solution I contributed to worked by [brief, plain-language explanation of the approach]. My specific role was [your individual contribution - e.g. I built the module that extracted and validated data from uploaded invoices and integrated it with the

approval workflow]. It was a great learning experience in understanding how a product moves from an idea to something used by real users.

Besides that, I've worked on a few academic projects. One of them was [Project Name], where along with my team we built [one-line idea]. My role there was to [your contribution], and we approached the problem by [approach in plain language, no tech stack].

I've also worked on [second project, one line], where I was responsible for [contribution].

Outside academics, I've been involved with [club/event], where I [what you did - organised/volunteered/led], which helped me build [one thing you learned - e.g. coordination and ownership].

In my free time, I enjoy [hobby].

Coming to why I want to join [Company Name] - I've been following [specific product/initiative/value of the company], and I find [specific reason tied to your research] really exciting. It aligns well with what I want to work on, and I believe this role would let me contribute meaningfully while growing in that direction.

Thank you for your time - I'm happy to go deeper into any of this.

Tune the length up or down depending on how much time you're given - if asked for a "quick intro," drop to 30–40 seconds by compressing the projects section to one line each.

3. Interview Behavioural Tips

General conduct

- Be clear and concise - answer the question asked, then stop. Don't ramble to fill silence.
- Give the idea first, technical detail second. Interviewers usually want to know you understand the "why" before the "how."
- Own your contributions honestly. Say "I built/implemented/decided" for your part, and "we" for team decisions - don't overclaim or underclaim.
- If you don't know something, say so briefly, then reason through it out loud instead of guessing silently or going quiet.
- Maintain eye contact (or camera contact, if virtual), sit upright, and keep a calm, steady pace of speech.

- Ask a thoughtful question at the end when invited to - about the team, the tech, or the role, not about salary/leave at the first opportunity.

Before the interview

- Research the company: what it builds, its recent news/product launches, its mission, and where this role fits.
- Re-read your own resume the night before - assume every line can be asked about.
- Re-derive the key decisions in your projects: why you chose a certain approach, what alternatives you considered, what you'd improve.
- Prepare 2–3 STAR stories in advance (see below) so you're not building them live under pressure.

The STAR Method

Use this structure to answer any "tell me about a time when..." or situational question. It keeps your answer focused and complete.

- Situation - briefly set the context. Where, when, what was happening. 1–2 sentences.
- Task - what exactly was your responsibility or the goal you were working towards.
- Action - what you specifically did. This is the longest part - be concrete, use "I" not "we" for your own actions.
- Result - the outcome, ideally with a measurable or clear impact, and what you learned.

Keep each STAR answer to about 1–1.5 minutes. Practice 3–4 stories from your internship, projects, and leadership experience that can flex to answer different behavioural questions (conflict, failure, leadership, deadline pressure, teamwork).

Common Managerial / Situational Questions to Prepare For

1. Tell me about a time you disagreed with a teammate or team lead. How did you handle it?
2. Describe a situation where you had to meet a tight deadline. What did you do?
3. Tell me about a time you made a mistake. How did you fix it?
4. Describe a time you had to work with someone difficult or uncooperative.
5. Tell me about a time you had to learn something new quickly for a project.
6. Describe a situation where a project didn't go as planned. What did you do?
7. Tell me about a time you took initiative without being asked.
8. How do you prioritise when you have multiple deadlines at once?
9. Tell me about a time you had to convince someone to see things your way.
10. Describe a time you received critical feedback. How did you respond?
11. Why do you want to work here, and why this role specifically?
12. Where do you see yourself in the next few years, and how does this role fit that?

What the interviewer is really evaluating

Through all of this - the self-intro, the project deep-dives, and the behavioural questions - the interviewer is forming one overall picture. Keep this in mind through the whole interview:

- You clearly understand everything you've worked on - no vague or memorised-sounding answers.
- You show genuine interest in this company specifically, backed by real research, not generic enthusiasm.
- You know what the company does - its products, its space, and ideally something current about it.
- Your goals and interests genuinely align with the role and the company's direction, not just "any job will do."
- You communicate clearly, stay composed, and can think on your feet in unscripted moments.